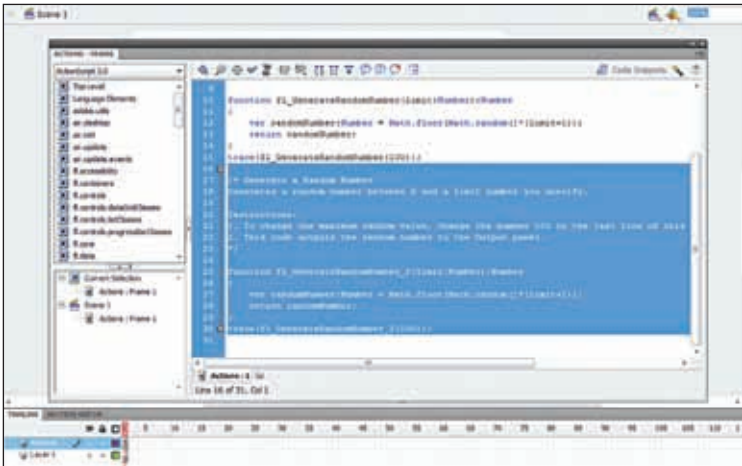




Generating Random Numbers Action

Working with classes

A common design pattern in object-oriented programs separates design, programming, and data elements. Flash CS5 adds this functionality with the inclusion of classes. A class is a packaged document that you can use to explain how UI components, business logic, and data elements will interact.

A class is a separate ActionScript file that is associated with the main Flash file and movie clips. You can use Flash CS5 as the class file editor or your favourite text editor such as Eclipse, Notepad, or TextEdit. A Class file is only a text file. It is very easy to create entire Flash movies using just Class files and not even add any content into a traditional timeline.

These steps will show you how to create a simple Class file for your Flash movies:

1. Create a new AS3 file. Save the file and name it "helloWorld.fla".
2. In the new, blank helloWorld.fla file open the Properties panel.
3. Expand the Publish setting. You will see a Class field. To the right-hand side of the Class field is a small pencil icon. Select the icon. A new window will open asking you if you want to create a new class. Create a new class and call it helloClass.
4. A new ActionScript file will open. Notice that the file is now labeled helloClass. The class is a default, blank class with the ActionScript.